Fairthorne and Thornhill

8.7 The Fairthorne and Thornhill area is located south of South Marston Village and will provide a sensitive expansion to the village. The development will respond positively to its surrounding character and context to deliver an attractive residential area within South Marston.

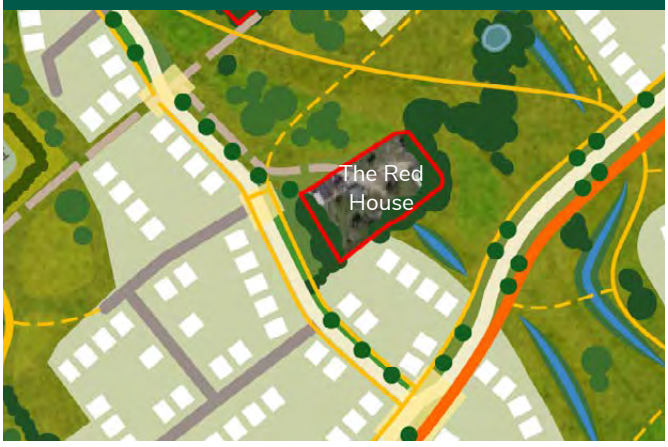
8.8 Key design principles:

- The main vehicular access will be provided from Thornhill Road via main street with connection to Old Vicarage Lane.
- A variety of densities will be included through the character area.
- An important feature will be the interface between development and the main areas of formal and informal open space that characterise the village expansion area.
- Development fronting onto adjoining open space will provide opportunities for overlooking.
- Retained trees and hedgerows will provide a strong framework for the open spaces with opportunities for additional tree planting.
- Local and neighbourhood play areas will be accommodated close to the main area of formal playing pitches adjoining the village centre.
- Detailed design will have regard to the setting of the listed buildings.
- Pedestrian and cycle access will be provided from the development into the green infrastructure, connecting the wider development.
- Opportunities to provide new access points to the Oxleaze Community Woodland can be explored at the detail design stage - to be agreed with the woodland managing body.
- Potential other access arrangements to Thornhill Road via other parties' land and land to the north to be explored in the Character Area Design Code.

Primary Route
Secondary Route
Bridleway
Connected Informal Open Space
Public Spaces
Play Area
Informal Open Space
Formal Sports
Listed Building
Site Access

1 Thornhill Park - A pocket park to the back of the Manor Farmhouse creates a central focus for the new residential area and provides a set back to the listed building.

2 The Red House - Retained vegetation and development set back define the interface between the new development and the listed building



Marston Gate and Nightingale Corner

8.9 Marston Gate and Nightingale Corner area is located to either side of Old Vicarage Lane between Nightingale Lane in the north and the proposed junction with the main street in the south. This character area should deliver a sensitive, contextual response to the existing eastern edge of South Marston.

8.10 Key design principles:

- The character area will be important in helping to define the appearance of the village expansion area from Old Vicarage Lane. This character area should deliver a sensitive, contextual response to the existing eastern edge of South Marston.
- The primary street will run through the character area providing access and a structuring element which development will front onto.
- A gateway design to be established at the new access point on Old Vicarage Lane.
- Dwellings that front Old Vicarage Lane will have direct access from Old Vicarage Lane, seeking to minimise hedgerow removal, either via individual driveways or private driveways to groups of dwellings.
- Houses reflecting the existing character of development along Old Vicarage Lane will be appropriate within this area with opportunities for higher densities within residential blocks and lower densities addressing the open space.
- Pedestrian and cycle route, together with bridleways, will provide connections to the wider development and green infrastructure.
- Play area and community orchard, as part of wider landscape framework, will be accommodated within the heart of this area.
- Pedestrian and cycle permeability to be allowed across the boundary along the bridleway to the north, to offer access to Vicarage Gardens.

Primary Route

Verdant character of Old Vicarage Lane to be retained

Bridleway

Connected Informal Open Space

Public Spaces

Play Area

Community Orchard

Informal Open Space

3 Marston Gate - Retained trees and an area of community open space will 'stitch' the northern and southern parcel, facilitating social interaction among residents.

Valley View and Neighbourhood Hub

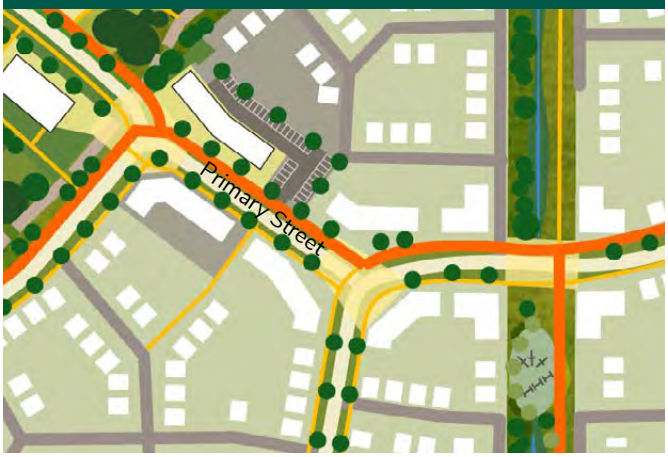
8.11 The Valley View and Neighbourhood Hub area occupies the south facing slopes of Rowborough overlooking the South Marston Brook Valley.

8.12 Key design principles:

- Development will respond to the gentle contours which fall to the south and west towards the South Marston Brook Valley. Houses will be orientated, where appropriate, to take advantage of views across the valley.
- A softer parkland edge will be established where development adjoins the open space.
- Play spaces and allotments will be accommodated within the wider landscape framework which will also support informal recreation routes.
- The Neighbourhood Hub will support a mix of education, local retail and community uses. It will be centrally located in Rowborough on the main street in order to provide good walkable catchments for the majority of future residents and to maximise accessibility of local services and facilities.
- Co-location of facilities will establish a focal point and a meeting place for the wider development. Residential development will include some higher density housing.
- Detailed design will have regard to the setting of Rowborough Farm.
- The approaches to the Neighbourhood Hub from Old Vicarage Lane will have a green character, reinforcing the sense of approaching a village through rural edge and ensuring appropriate separation from South Marston across the South Marston Brook corridor.
- Pedestrian and cycle route, together with bridleways, will provide connections to the wider development and green infrastructure.
- SBC Safe School Environment Zone (SSEZ) programme to inform the design of the areas surrounding the school.

Primary Route
Secondary Route
Bridleway
Connected Informal Open Space
Public Spaces
South Marston Brook
Informal Open Space
Allotments
Play Area
Retained Farm Buildings
Primary School
Local Centre

4 Neighbourhood Hub - Design of key junctions to highlight their role as way-marker and provide safe crossings alongside incidental open space.



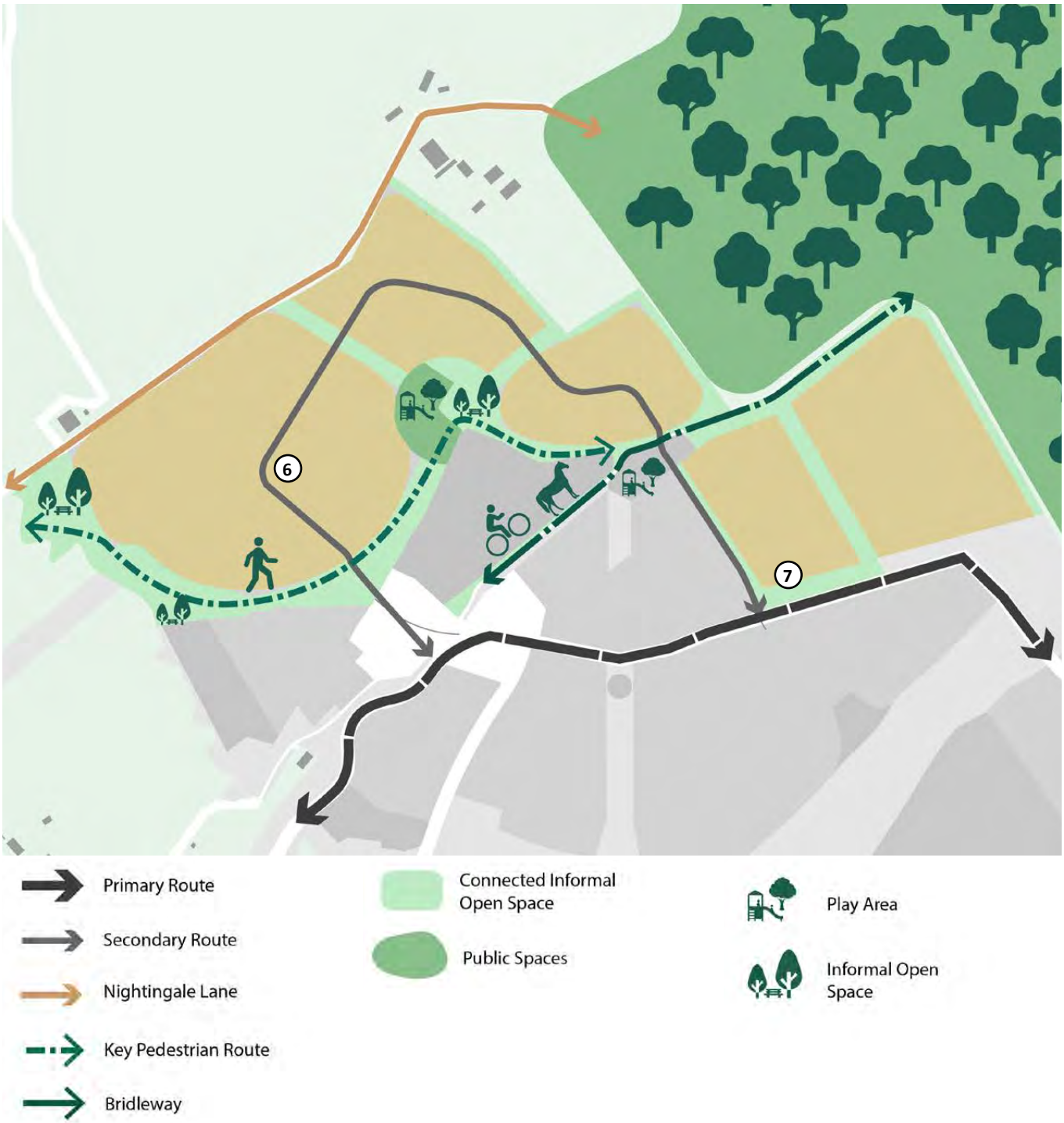
5 Rowborough Farm (Non-designated heritage asset) - Access to Rowborough farm and the farm building will be preserved and enhanced by open space, creating a node which highlights the heritage setting of the site.

Nightingale Edge

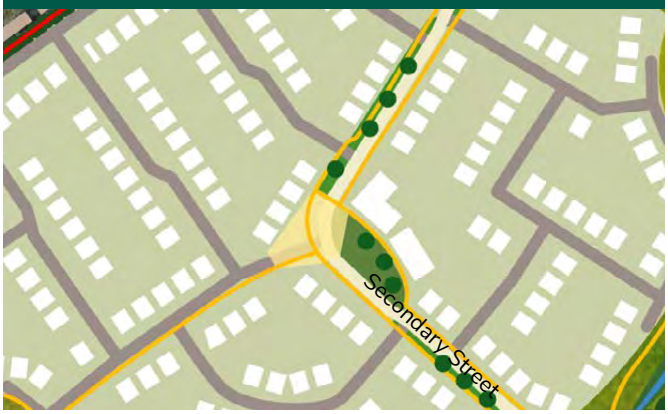
8.13 The Nightingale Edge character area is located at the highest point of Rowborough and will address the north-eastern development edge adjoining Nightingale Wood and areas of open countryside.

8.14 Key design principles:

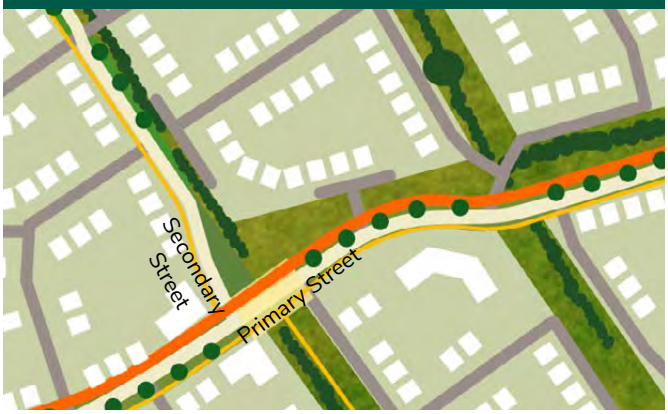
- Given the topography, with views out towards South Marston and the wider New Eastern Villages area to the south, and location adjoining Nightingale Wood, a more informal development layout will be appropriate. This will help to define the eastern edge of Rowborough and accord with the landscape proposals in the area.
- Visual and physical linkages will be provided along existing hedgerows, footpaths and bridleways into Nightingale Wood from Rowborough.
- The area will be accessed via secondary loop with connections to the main street.
- A softer parkland edge will be established where development adjoins the open space.
- Play spaces will be accommodated within the landscape framework as well as opportunities for informal recreation and habitat creation.
- Detailed design will have regard to the setting of Nightingale Farmhouse.



6 Nightingale Green - Pockets of open space to identify key locations within residential parcels with opportunities for accent buildings to reinforce their wayfinding role.



7 Rowborough Green - Existing network of retained hedgerows to be interconnected by pocket areas of open space giving an overall verdant appearance to the primary street.

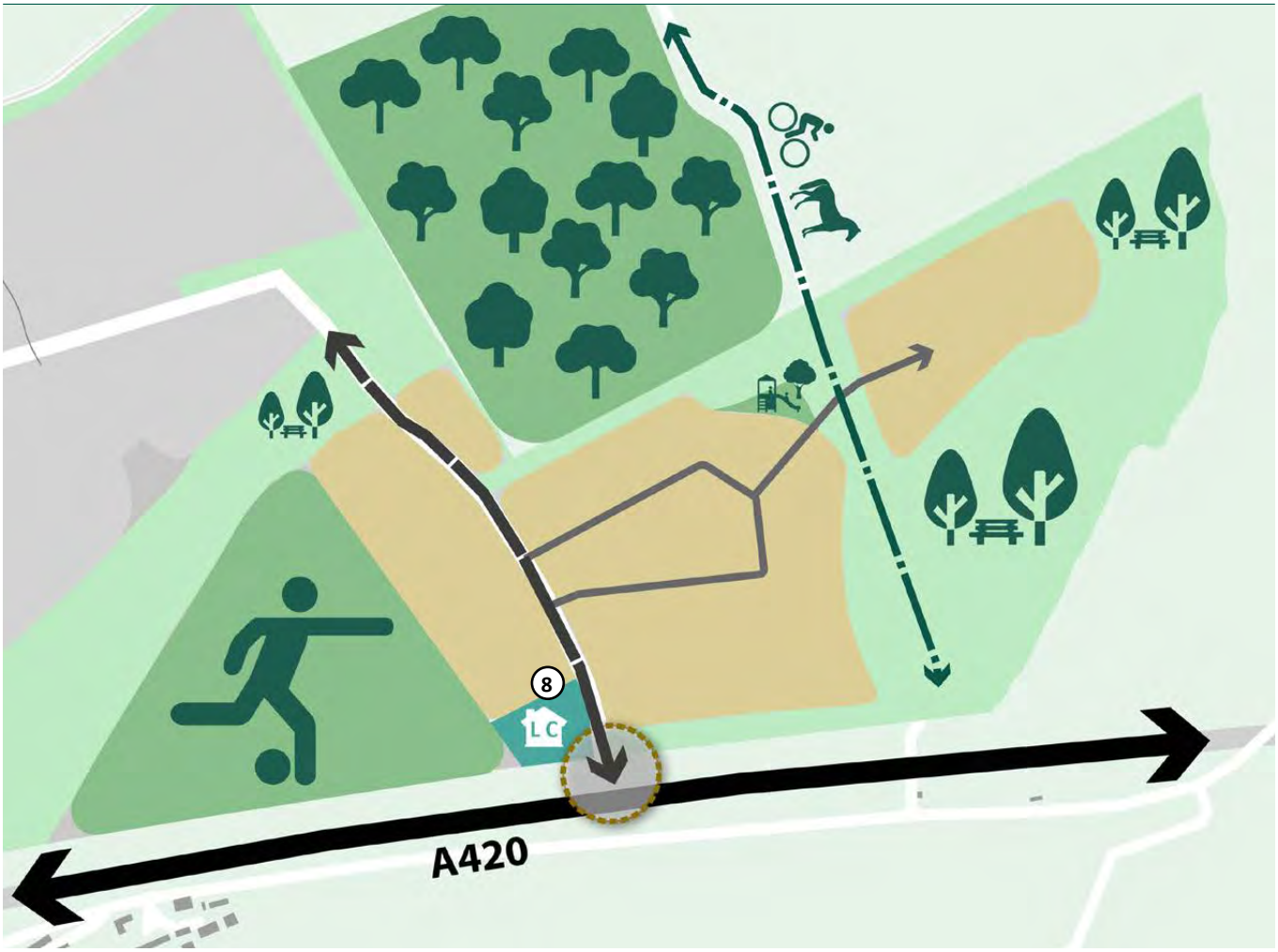


Rowborough Gate

8.15 Rowborough Gate area is located at the south eastern part of new village area, adjoining the main street and proposed access to A420.

8.16 Key design principles:

- Establish a gateway on southern entrance to Rowborough signalling the new built edge of the New Eastern Villages. This will be achieved through frontage development and landscape planting defining the main multi-modal street.
- The main street will provide clear and legible onward linkages towards the Neighbourhood Hub and other parts of Rowborough.
- Given the close proximity to the A420 and the Park and Ride facility to be created as part of the development south of the A420, a higher density development will be appropriate in proximity to the access and along the railway.
- Lower densities and a sensitive interface with the existing landscape will be required to the east of the site and along the woodland edge to the north.
- The mixed use area will support small scale local retail and commercial uses, but equally provide opportunities arising from co-location with sports and recreation provision.
- The location of key sports pitch facilities will be provided as part of the wider Green Infrastructure Framework of parkland.
- Play spaces will be accommodated within the landscape framework as well as opportunities for informal recreation and habitat creation.



Primary Route

Secondary Route

Bridleway

Connected Informal Open Space

Public Spaces

Play Area

Informal Open Space

Formal Sports

Mixed Use

Site Access

8 Eastern Gateway - Public realm to create a gateway into the new development and favour safe crossings of cycle and pedestrian route along the northern side of the railway embankment.

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